ODOO FOR MANUFACTURERS: INDEPENDENT ADVISORY

Randy Wolf · Artifexo Fabrika · Columbus, Ohio

THE GAP

Most Odoo implementations succeed at finance and inventory, then stall at the floor. The recipe is written to the specification sheet, not to what the line actually runs. The routing says eight minutes; the floor says fourteen. Traceability is configured for the auditor, not for the recall. By go-live the plant has built a shadow spreadsheet to cover the difference, and the ERP is trusted for everything except the thing it was bought for.

That is not a software problem. It is a process problem wearing a software costume, and it is closed by someone who has run a plant.

WHAT I EXAMINE

1. **Recipes and BoMs against actual production.** Component quantities, scrap factors, alternates, and the specific places where the bill of materials and the floor disagree.
2. **Routings and work centers.** Standard times that survive contact with the line, capacity that reflects real changeovers, and the setup matrix the scheduler needs in order to be believed.
3. **Production planning and scheduling.** Order to cash, demand to supply, and whether the plan the system produces is one the plant can actually run on Monday morning.
4. **Lot control and traceability.** Lot and serial assignment at the point of consumption, shelf life and expiry logic, hold and release, and a recall path that can be walked forward and backward in one pass.
5. **Changeover and setup standards.** Where the minutes actually go, which components drive each change, and how to encode that so the schedule stops lying about available capacity.
6. **Commissioning and line installation overlap.** Where a new line or a retrofit meets an existing Odoo configuration, and whether the routing, work center, and capacity data reflect the equipment as installed rather than as specified.

HOW I WORK

- **Implementation review.** A fixed-scope review of the proposed design and configuration against real plant process, delivered as a written risk register and a go-live readiness opinion.
- **Fractional advisory.** Ten to twenty hours a week through implementation, attending design and steering meetings as the independent operations voice. Four to six months is typical.
- **Pre-go-live audit.** A short, blunt assessment of testing coverage, data migration readiness, and whether the plant can cut over, delivered to the executive sponsor rather than to the project team.

WHY ME

Thirty years in manufacturing operations. At Treasury Wine Estates I was Lean Manager for a bottling operation in a regulated food and beverage environment, where lot traceability, shelf life, and recall exposure are operational facts rather than configuration options. I later held a capital projects role installing new bottling lines, which is where I learned what a routing looks like on the day the equipment is commissioned and nothing matches the vendor’s drawing. There I raised First Time Quality from 84% to 95% in 180 days.

At Gallant North America I grew a small office furniture manufacturer from $350,000 to over $8 million in 42 months, supplying Herman Miller, Steelcase, Knoll, and Kimball. At The Kingswood Company I eliminated mandatory overtime and the need for a second shift while improving quality and reducing returns. In Shanghai I designed and maintained quality control procedures for Tier 2 and Tier 3 suppliers to leading automotive companies.

I have configured Odoo for manufacturing and I know where it bends. I have also been the plant manager who has to live with the configuration after the consultant leaves, which is the perspective most implementations are missing. I will give you an independent view rather than validate a vendor.

CONTACT

Randy Wolf · Artifexo Fabrika · Columbus, Ohio +1 415.275.0508 · randy.d.wolf@proton.me · artifexofabrika.com Working demo of the production tracking platform I built and run: artifexofabrika.com/demo